

Title Changes Meaning Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 20-30 min

Category	The Arts	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	title-changes-meaning

Big idea: Context changes interpretation.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students experience how context changes artistic interpretation.

Student Prompt

Inspect Title Changes Meaning Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Title Changes Meaning Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: The same image titled 'Waiting', 'Evidence', 'Aftermath', and 'Home'. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Title Changes Meaning Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Students interpret before and after seeing titles. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Title Changes Meaning Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A title-writing round where students try to control audience interpretation. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Context changes interpretation.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Title Changes Meaning Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Title Changes Meaning Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	Does the artist control the meaning of an artwork?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how context changes interpretation.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: Does the artist control the meaning of an artwork?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: The same image titled 'Waiting', 'Evidence', 'Aftermath', and 'Home'.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- The same image titled 'Waiting', 'Evidence', 'Aftermath', and 'Home'.
- Students interpret before and after seeing titles.
- A title-writing round where students try to control audience interpretation.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/title-changes-meaning/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/title-changes-meaning/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/title-changes-meaning/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Show the same image with Title A. Students write a one-sentence interpretation.
2. Repeat with Title B and Title C.
3. Students compare how their interpretation changed.
4. Discuss whether the title revealed meaning or created it.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: Does the artist control the meaning of an artwork?

- Can interpretation be wrong?
- What kind of knowledge can art provide?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...